Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto's Transportation Planning division, where reviewing the transportation studies filed with development applications is a core part of the work. Has modelled road closures and staging in Synchro and rail operations in OpenTrack, and analyzes travel data in Python and SQL.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Analyze large volumes of travel and network data for trends, gaps and emerging issues, and turn them into KPIs and data-driven recommendations.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work, holding the schedule and quality myself, and reporting progress to the people relying on it.
- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions.
- Advise on by-laws and regulations that bear on the City's roads and right-of-way.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Traffic simulation: Synchro and VISSIM; MATSim and OpenTrack. Review of traffic and transportation studies. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and advanced Excel. AutoCAD, Civil 3D, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS. Technical reports and presentations. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)